Overall Process Flow

Lead Generation → Lead Qualification → Site Survey → Proposal → Customer Confirmation → Advance → Documentation → DISCOM Application → Technical Feasibility → Procurement → Installation → Inspection/Commissioning → Net Metering → Final Payment → Subsidy Claim → Subsidy Receipt → Project Closure

STAGE 1 — LEAD GENERATION

1. Lead Sources

Leads can come from:

• Direct marketing
• References
• Existing customers
• Business Associates
• Digital marketing
• Website enquiries
• Social media
• WhatsApp campaigns
• Exhibitions/events
• Electrical contractors
• Builders
• Architects
• Employee references
• Existing O&M customers

2. Lead Registration

Every lead should immediately be entered into a Lead Management/CRM system.

Capture:

• Lead ID
• Customer name
• Mobile number
• Location
• Consumer number
• Electricity board/DISCOM

• Monthly electricity bill
• Average monthly consumption
• Sanctioned load
• Roof type
• Approximate roof area
• Customer category
• Required system size
• Lead source
• Sales person
• Date of enquiry

Important: No lead should remain only in a salesperson's WhatsApp or notebook.

STAGE 2 — LEAD QUALIFICATION

The salesperson should determine whether the lead is actually viable.

Qualification checklist

Customer

• Residential / Commercial / Industrial
• Owner / Tenant
• Decision maker identified?

Electricity

• Monthly consumption
• Annual consumption
• Current tariff
• Sanctioned load
• Existing rooftop solar?

Roof

• RCC / Sheet / Other
• Shadow-free area
• Structural condition
• Orientation
• Accessibility

Financial

• Customer budget

• Financing requirement
• Expected investment
• Subsidy eligibility

Lead Classification

Category	Meaning
A	Hot / Ready to buy
B	Potential
C	Future
D	Not feasible

STAGE 3 — SITE SURVEY

This is one of the most critical stages.

The survey team should collect:

Electrical Data

• Electricity bill
• Consumer number
• Meter details
• Sanctioned load
• Existing DB
• Cable route
• Earthing
• AC/DC requirements

Roof Data

• Roof dimensions
• Available area
• Shadow analysis
• Roof condition
• Height
• Access
• Water tanks
• Existing structures
• Parapet walls
• Future construction possibilities

Photographs

Take photographs of:

- Roof
- Meter
- Main DB
- Electrical panel
- Cable route
- Inverter location
- Building elevation
- Obstacles
- Earthing point

Survey Output

Site Survey Report + Roof Layout + Proposed System Capacity

STAGE 4 — SYSTEM DESIGN & DPR

Based on the survey:

Engineering team prepares

- System capacity
- Module selection
- Inverter selection
- Structure design
- String configuration
- DC cable
- AC cable
- Protection systems
- Earthing
- Lightning protection
- Generation estimate
- Shadow analysis
- Single Line Diagram
- Roof layout

For larger systems, prepare a proper DPR / technical proposal.

STAGE 5 — COMMERCIAL PROPOSAL

Prepare the customer quotation.

It should clearly mention:

Scope

• Solar modules
• Inverter
• Mounting structure
• DC/AC cables
• Earthing
• Lightning protection
• Installation
• Testing & commissioning
• Net meter coordination
• Documentation
• Warranty
• O&M, if applicable

Commercial Terms

For example:

• System Cost
• GST
• Total Project Value
• Subsidy — if applicable
• Customer Net Payable
• Payment Schedule

Example:

10% — Booking/Order
40% — Material Procurement
40% — Installation/Before Commissioning
10% — Commissioning/Net Metering

The actual payment structure can vary by company policy.

STAGE 6 — CUSTOMER CLOSURE

Once the customer accepts:

Obtain

• Signed quotation
• Purchase Order / Work Order
• Customer agreement
• KYC documents
• Electricity bill
• Aadhaar/PAN as applicable
• Bank details
• Property/ownership documents where required
• Subsidy-related documents
• Photographs
• Cancelled cheque where applicable

Create

Customer Project File / Project ID

From this point, every document should carry the same Project ID.

STAGE 7 — ADVANCE PAYMENT

Before procurement/major execution:

Sales → Accounts

Accounts confirms:

• Advance received
• Receipt generated
• Payment matched with customer
• GST invoice requirements
• Outstanding amount

Only after financial clearance should the project move to procurement, according to the company's approved process.

STAGE 8 — DISCOM / PORTAL PROCESS

This stage is particularly important for grid-connected rooftop systems.

Depending on the applicable scheme and DISCOM:

Application

Customer/application details are submitted through the applicable portal.
Then:
Application → Technical Feasibility → Approval → Installation →
Inspection/Commissioning → Metering/Agreement
The exact sequence can vary by DISCOM and scheme.
For residential subsidy projects under the current central rooftop-solar framework,
the applicable national portal and DISCOM procedures need to be followed.

STAGE 9 — PROCUREMENT & MATERIAL PLANNING

After order confirmation:

Procurement team prepares

Material Requirement / BOM

For example:

- Solar modules
- Inverter
- Structure
- DC cables
- AC cables
- MC4 connectors
- DCDB
- ACDB
- Earthing materials
- Lightning arrester
- Conduits
- Cable trays
- Fasteners
- Labels
- Safety equipment

Procurement Controls

Purchase Order → Vendor → Material Received → QC → GRN → Store → Project Issue
Every material should be traceable to the Project ID.

STAGE 10 — INSTALLATION

Now the project moves from office to site.

Installation sequence

Site mobilisation
↓
Safety briefing
↓
Material receipt
↓
Structure installation
↓
Module installation
↓
DC cabling
↓
Inverter installation
↓
AC cabling
↓
ACDB/DCDB
↓
Earthing
↓
Lightning protection
↓
Cable dressing & labelling
↓
Monitoring system
↓
Testing

STAGE 11 — TESTING & COMMISSIONING

Before handover, conduct a proper commissioning checklist.

Check

• Module installation
• Structure torque
• Cable polarity
• String voltage
• Insulation resistance
• Earthing resistance
• Inverter parameters
• AC voltage
• DC voltage
• Protection devices
• Generation
• Monitoring
• Safety labels

Documentation

Prepare:

• Installation Completion Report
• Testing & Commissioning Report
• As-Built Drawing
• Photographs
• Serial Numbers
• Warranty Documents

STAGE 12 — DISCOM INSPECTION / NET METERING

After installation:

Installation completion → DISCOM inspection → Metering process → Net meter / applicable metering arrangement → Grid synchronization

The exact process varies by DISCOM.

This stage should have a dedicated Net Metering Tracker.

Track:

Activity Status

Application

Activity Status
Feasibility
Installation
Inspection request
Inspection
Meter approval
Meter installation
Synchronisation

STAGE 13 — FINAL BILLING & PAYMENT

This is where many EPC companies lose control.
After agreed project milestone completion:
Accounts generates
Final Invoice
Then:
Invoice → Customer → Payment Follow-up → Receipt → Outstanding = ZERO
The project should not be considered financially closed merely because installation is complete.
You need:
Technical Closure
AND
Commercial Closure
Both are required.

STAGE 14 — SUBSIDY PROCESS

For eligible residential rooftop projects, subsidy processing should be treated as a separate workflow rather than assuming that installation automatically means subsidy receipt.
Broadly:
Eligible Customer
↓

Application / Registration
↓
DISCOM / Technical Process
↓
Installation
↓
Inspection / Commissioning
↓
Required Documentation
↓
Subsidy Claim / Verification
↓
Approval
↓
Subsidy Released
↓
Customer Bank Account / Applicable Payment Route

The exact current subsidy amount, eligibility, documentation and release mechanism should be verified against the applicable government scheme and current portal/DISCOM rules before quoting the customer.

STAGE 15 — SUBSIDY RECEIPT & PROJECT CLOSURE

Once subsidy is credited:

Accounts should capture

- Subsidy application ID
- Customer name
- Project ID
- Approved capacity
- Eligible subsidy
- Approved subsidy amount
- Date of approval
- Date of credit
- Amount credited

• Bank transaction reference

• Subsidy receipt/proof

Then:

PROJECT STATUS

CLOSED — TECHNICAL + COMMERCIAL + SUBSIDY

THE MOST IMPORTANT NIRT CONTROL SYSTEM

LEAD

↓

LEAD QUALIFICATION

↓

SITE SURVEY

↓

TECHNICAL DESIGN

↓

QUOTATION

↓

NEGOTIATION

↓

CUSTOMER CONFIRMATION

↓

ADVANCE PAYMENT

↓

DOCUMENT COLLECTION

↓

DISCOM APPLICATION

↓

FEASIBILITY / APPROVAL

↓

PROCUREMENT

↓

MATERIAL RECEIPT & QC

↓
SITE INSTALLATION
↓
TESTING
↓
COMMISSIONING
↓
DISCOM INSPECTION
↓
NET METERING
↓
FINAL INVOICE
↓
FINAL PAYMENT
↓
SUBSIDY CLAIM
↓
SUBSIDY APPROVAL
↓
SUBSIDY RECEIPT
↓
CUSTOMER HANDOVER
↓
WARRANTY / O&M
↓
PROJECT CLOSED

Dividing responsibility into 8 departments

Stage	Primary Owner
Lead Generation	Sales
Lead → Order	Sales
Survey → Design	Engineering
Procurement	Purchase
Installation	Project/EPC

Stage	Primary Owner
DISCOM/Net Meter	Liaison/Project
Billing & Collection	Accounts
Subsidy	Subsidy/Project Coordinator
Final Closure	Project Manager

And one person should act as the Project Coordinator / Control Tower.

That person doesn't necessarily execute everything—but ensures nothing gets stuck between departments.